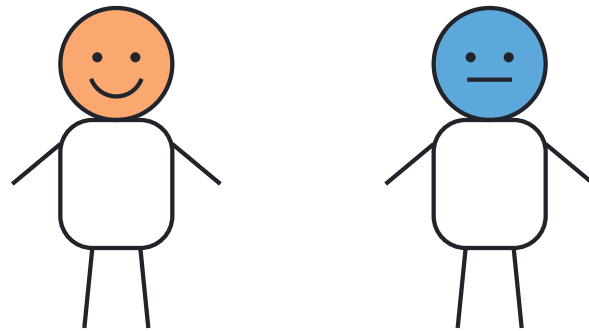




LITTLE FEELINGS SOCIAL STORIES



Safe Ways to Handle Big Feelings

A Calm-Down Toolkit Social Story

Written by Daniel Tesfamariam

Ages 4-8 - Calm-down toolkit

A read-aloud social story with activities

Home - Classroom - Counseling

How to Share This Book

Social stories gently walk a child through a situation and model calm, kind choices. Read this book together, more than once. The repetition is what helps - it lets a child rehearse the feelings and choices before the real moment happens.

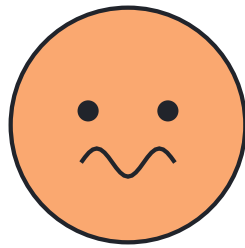
This book helps a child understand the feeling, see that it is normal, and practice calm, kind choices - before the real moment happens.

How to use it

- Read the story slowly and out loud, pointing at the pictures.
- Read it again on calm days - not only in the hard moment.
- Pause to let your child color, answer, or act out the pages.
- Praise effort and calm tries, not perfection.
- Use the calm-down tools together so they feel familiar later.

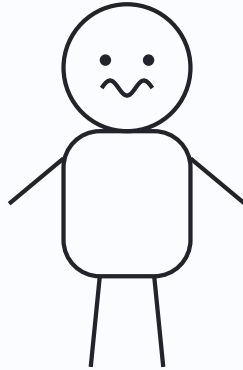
What's Inside

- 1 The Story: My Big Feelings
- 2 Feelings Faces
- 3 My Calm-Down Toolkit Cards
- 4 Breathing Cards
- 5 Where I Feel It
- 6 What Would You Do?
- 7 My Certificate



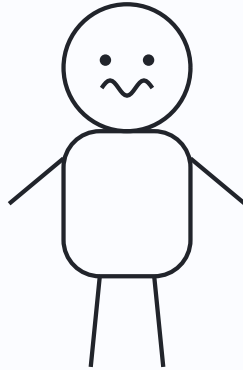
The Story

Big Feelings Are Okay



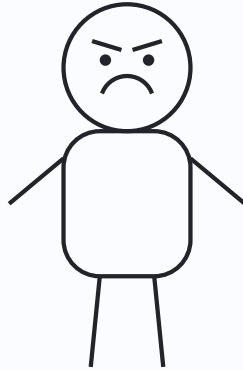
I have BIG feelings sometimes.

Anger, worry, sadness - they can feel huge inside me.

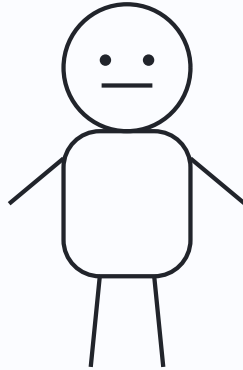


All feelings are okay to have.

Feelings are like waves - they get big, then they pass.

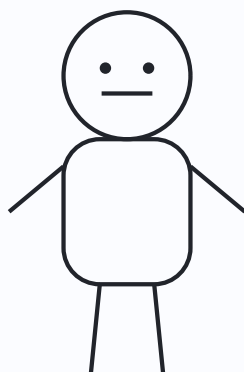


But big feelings can make me want to do unsafe things,
like hitting, yelling, or throwing. Those choices can hurt.



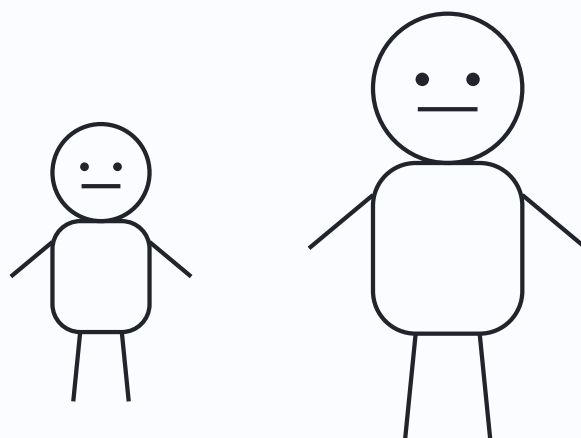
So I have a toolkit of SAFE ways to handle big feelings.

A tool is something I can do to help my body calm down.



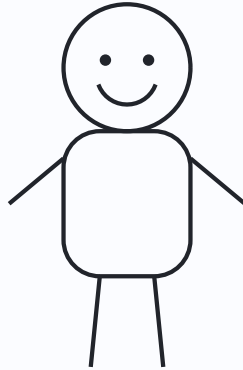
I can breathe slowly, squeeze something soft, or take a break.

I can move my body, draw, or ask for a hug.



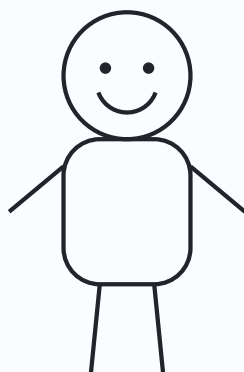
I can tell a safe grown-up how I feel.

'I feel...' helps them help me.



When I use my tools, my big feeling gets smaller.

I stay safe, and so does everyone around me.



I am learning which tools work best for ME.

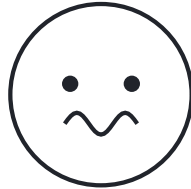
I am the boss of my body, even when feelings are big.

My Big Feelings

Color each face. Say the feeling out loud.



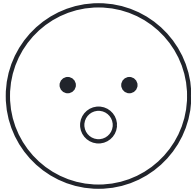
Angry



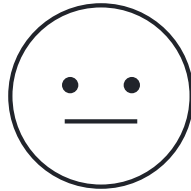
Worried



Sad



Overwhelmed



Calm



Okay Again

My Calm-Down Toolkit Cards

Cut out your toolkit cards. Try each one and keep your favorites close.

1 Slow Breaths

Breathe in slow, out slower.

2 Squeeze

Squeeze a pillow or stress ball.

3 Take a Break

Go to a calm, quiet spot.

4 Move

Stomp, jump, or stretch it out.

5 Draw It

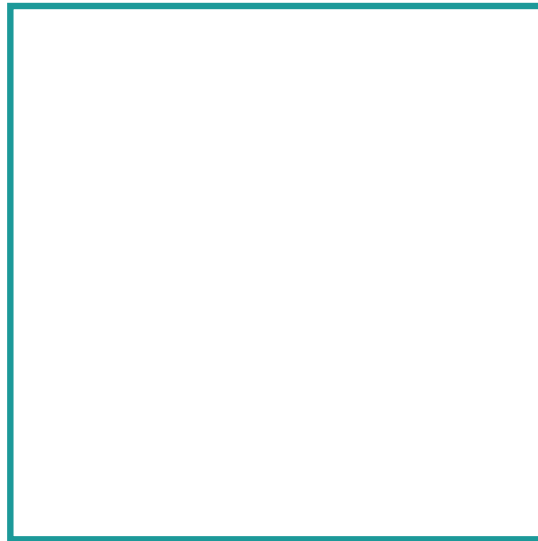
Draw or scribble your feeling.

6 Ask for a Hug

Ask a safe grown-up for a hug.

Belly Breathing

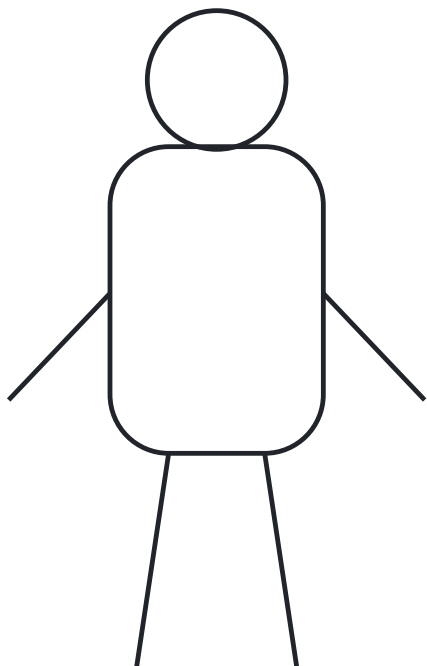
Trace the shape slowly with your finger while you breathe. Do it a few times until your body feels calmer.



1. Put a hand on your belly.
2. Breathe in slowly and feel it rise.
3. Breathe out slowly and feel it fall.
4. Do it until your body feels calmer.

Where I Feel My Feelings

Big feelings show up in our bodies. Color or mark where you feel yours. There are no wrong answers.



Color where you feel:

-  Hot / angry
-  Fluttery / worried
-  Heavy / sad
-  Calm / good

What Would You Do?

Read each situation together. There are many good choices! Talk it through, then write or draw what you could do.

- 1** You feel so angry you want to hit something.

What could you do?

- 2** You feel worried and your tummy hurts.

What could you do?

- 3** You feel sad and want to be alone.

What could you do?

My Calm-Down Toolkit

Out of all the tools in this book, which ones help YOU most? Draw or write your top tools here so you remember them when a big feeling comes.

1

2

3

4

5

What I Learned

- The most helpful thing I learned was...

- One thing I will try next time is...

My Feelings Journal

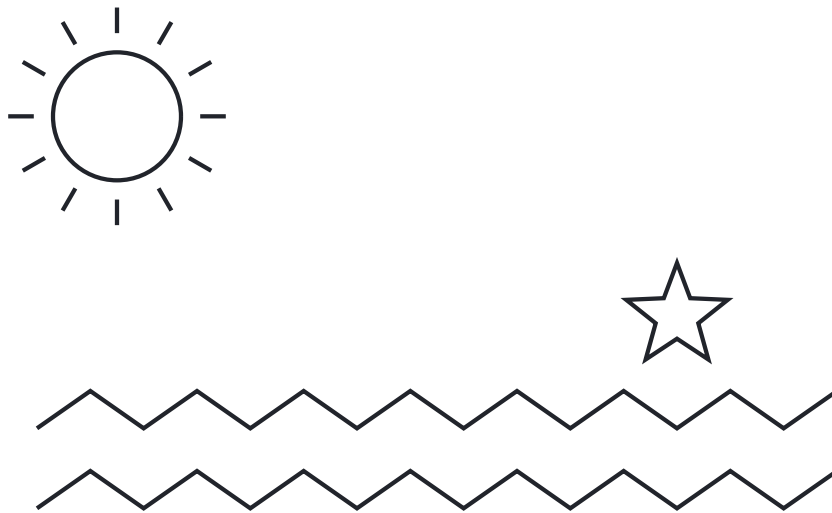
● A time I felt this feeling was...

● What helped me feel better was...

COLOR

My Calm Place

Draw and color a place where you feel calm and safe.



Color it in with colors that feel calm and happy.

WORDS

Calm Words to Trace

Trace the words. Then say them out loud.

I am safe.

I can ask for help.

This will pass.

People Who Help Me

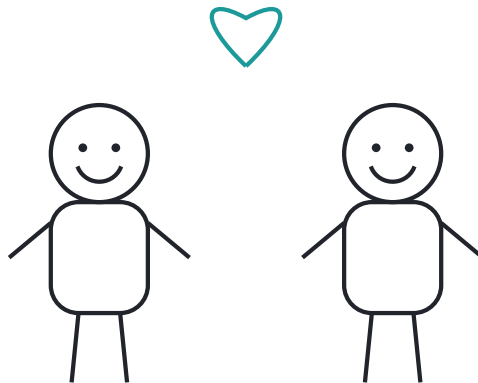
● Who are my safe grown-ups?

● How can they help me?

COLOR

Happy Together

Color two friends being kind to each other.



Color it in with colors that feel calm and happy.

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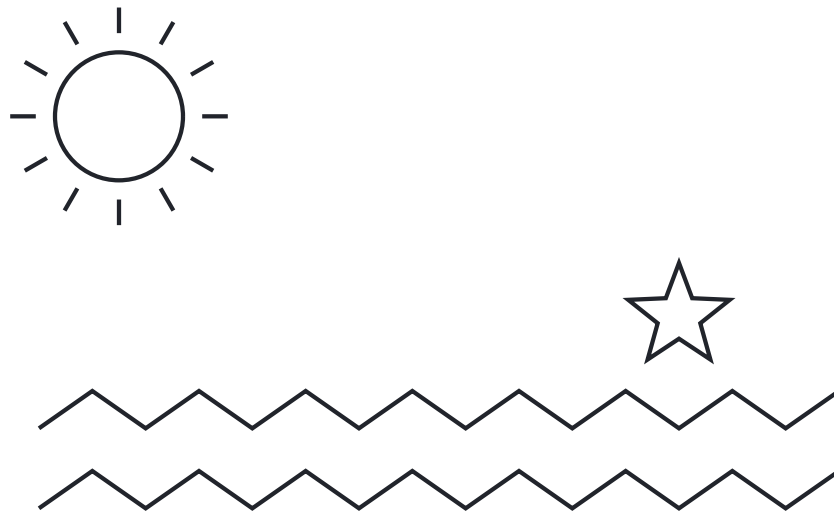
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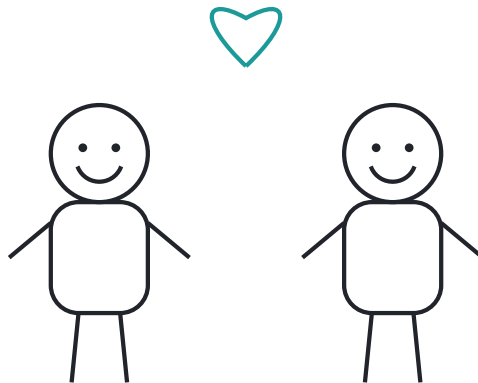
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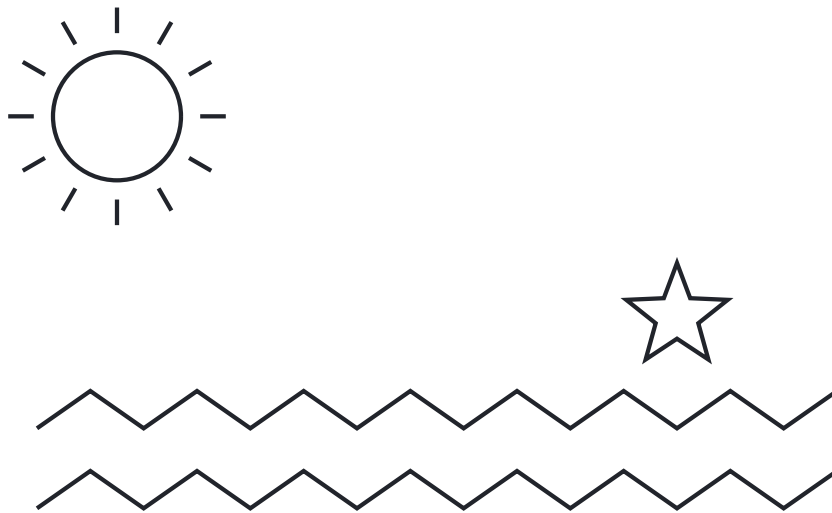
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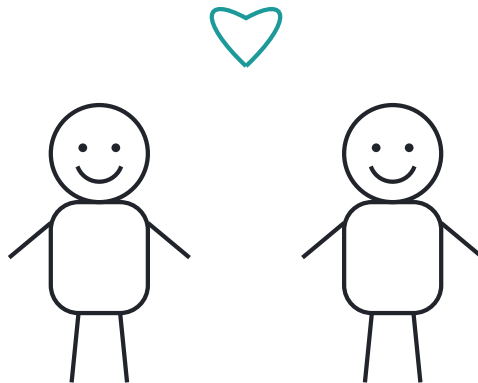
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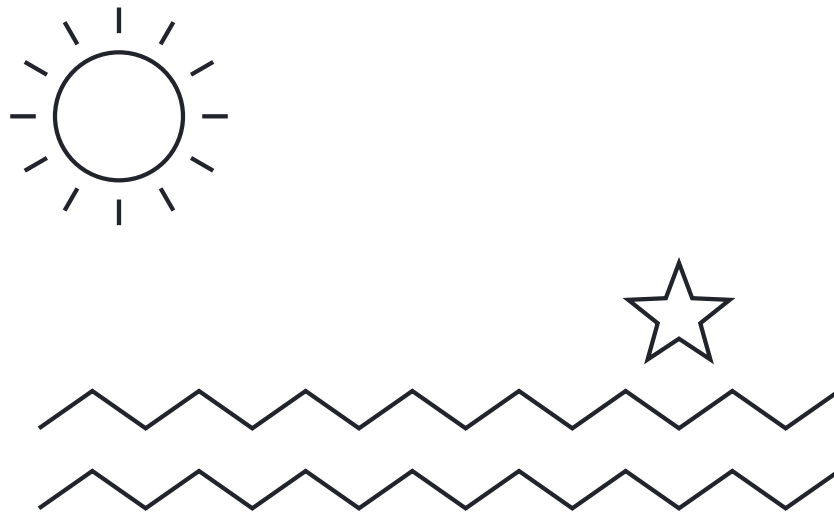
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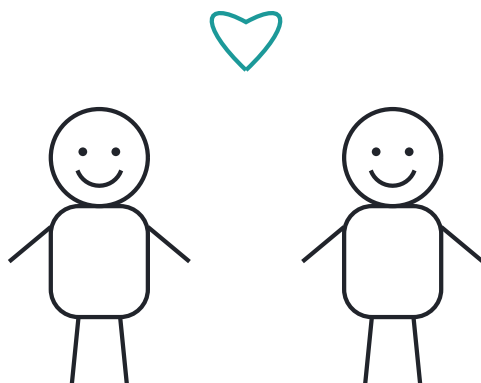
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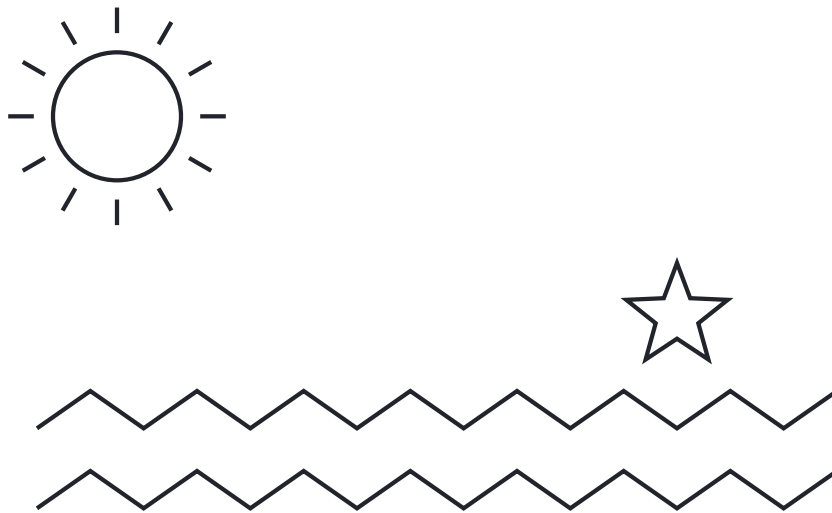
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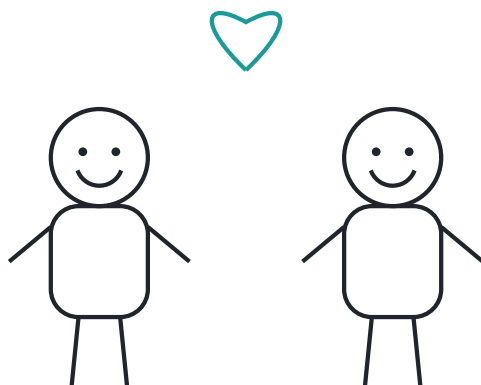
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CERTIFICATE

This certificate is proudly given to

(write your name)

for learning safe ways to handle big feelings!

Grown-up

Date